

Jason Herring

DESIGN TECHNOLOGIST / PRINCIPAL — CREATIVE ENGINEER

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PROFILE

Principal-level design technologist who ships — I write the code and direct the creative. 20+ years at the seam of design and engineering, now leading AI prototyping on Intuit's Foresight team: conversational and voice interfaces, real-time personality engines, and agentic systems that move from speculative demo to shipped product. Recently shipped Intuit Labs (public beta to 1M+ users) and Delphi (delphi.intuit.com).

I've architected AI-driven personality engines, created lifelike conversational avatars, and led immersive workshops that give creatives and executives hands-on fluency with emerging tech. Whether I'm teaching designers to code or designing systems that feel human, I'm chasing the same question: what happens when intelligence itself becomes a creative medium?

This is the moment. The tools are here. The only limit is what we're willing to prototype. I don't wait for the future — I make it visible. The goal: move beyond imagining the future, and prototype it.

EXPERIENCE

Intuit · Senior Staff Design Technologist — Foresight (AI) APR 2024 — PRESENT

Key builder on Foresight, Intuit's 100+ person AI innovation team (reporting into the Chief AI Officer org). Promoted Staff → Senior Staff, and served as Group Manager (Feb–Jun 2026) before returning to a senior IC leadership track to keep building.

- Shipped Intuit Labs — a public beta live to 1M+ international users, with rollout to all of QuickBooks underway — the surface that turns AI innovation prototypes into shipping product.
- Launched Delphi (delphi.intuit.com), an AI business advisor that turns QuickBooks data into forward-looking recommendations.
- Designed and built a real-time AI personality engine from scratch — natural language, emotional intelligence, and embodied avatars — on ultra-low-latency voice pipelines (Vapi, Hume, LiveKit, HeyGen).
- Delivered flagship demos at executive forums and summits that shifted how leadership invests in AI as a product medium.
- Built org-wide AI-literacy workshops (Demystifying Python, Shipping Conversations, AI Avatars & Voice), seeding hands-on fluency across teams.

Aleph · Director of Design and Technology MAR 2020 — APR 2024

Creative and technical leadership for an enterprise development studio. Managed engineering, design, and client relationships across React, React Native, Node, WordPress, and UX engagements.

- Increased annual revenue by more than 85% over four years through new client acquisition and expanded scopes.
- Directed a mobile app for Helix clinical trials — notifications, dashboards, and protocol compliance tools that increased user acquisition success by 22%.
- Led a complete studio rebrand: logo, typography, color, brand guidelines, and AI-assisted creative direction using Midjourney.
- Built and managed a team of 8 engineers and 3 designers across multiple concurrent client engagements.
- Introduced AI workflows (ChatGPT, Midjourney, Stable Diffusion) into the studio's design and development process.

SKILLS & EXPERTISE

- Conversational AI / Voice / Multi-Modal
- Generative AI / LLMs / RAG
- Prompt Engineering
- AI Personality & Agentic Systems
- Real-Time Voice Pipelines (Vapi, LiveKit, Hume, HeyGen)
- Rapid Prototyping / High-Fidelity Provocation
- Multi-Modal Interfaces / Voice UI
- Design Systems / Interaction Design / Figma
- Python / TypeScript / React / Next.js / Node.js
- API Design / Real-Time Systems
- Innovation Strategy / Design Technology Leadership
- Workshop Facilitation / Executive Communication

SELECT CLIENTS

Intuit · Nike · MoMA · Adidas · Stüssy ·
UNDFTD · Vans OTW · Pepsi · DreamWorks
· KQED · HUF · The North Face · Rebel8 ·
BART · Tracy Chapman / Elektra Records ·
Aesop Rock / Def Jux · Arta Tequila ·
Exploratorium

EDUCATION

University of South Florida, Tampa

English Literature

Dropped out senior year. Fell in love with the library and discovered the internet.

Hillsborough Community College, Tampa

Associate of Arts

Modernized how public media connects with its audience — leading design and technology that transformed KQED.org and the systems behind it. Focused on prototyping, modernization, and building the technical foundation for new kinds of storytelling.

- Led the multi-year redesign of KQED.org, partnering with design, engineering, product, and AlephSF to build a modern, accessible platform for public media in the Bay Area.
- Rebuilt the CI/CD pipeline, migrating Docker containers from AWS to Kubernetes on Google Cloud — enabling canary deployments, instant rollbacks, and faster experimentation.
- Migrated KQED's massive WordPress CMS to GCP Kubernetes, powering hundreds of thousands of articles and partner feeds (NPR, Apple News, Google News).
- Designed automated audio workflows for Alexa, Google Assistant, and NPR One — normalizing audio levels and publishing segmented clips for emerging voice platforms.
- Created real-time election infrastructure across every Bay Area county for 2018 — scrapers, editorial workflows, and automated publishing that made coverage fast and reliable.

KQED · Lead UX Designer

JAN 2015 — AUG 2018

Helped transform KQED's digital presence from a traditional broadcaster into a modern, audience-driven media platform — blending UX strategy, product design, and hands-on prototyping for millions of listeners and readers.

- The Listening Project: led a complete redesign of KQED Radio, News, Arts, Science, and the homepage — a persistent audio player, a flexible editorial content system, and a real-time “trending” experience.
- 2016 Election Voter Guide: spearheaded one of the first single-page apps deployed by a public media org — a custom WordPress-to-Elasticsearch pipeline and React front end that became a model for civic engagement design across NPR member stations.
- Prototyped and built a real-time election dashboard that drew 1M+ views on election night 2016.
- WordPress Modernization: migrated KQED's core properties into WordPress — first as an external vendor, then full-time — unifying content management and design across teams.

OrdinaryKids · Founder & Creative Director

JAN 2001 — JAN 2015

Formed in the midst of the dot-com fallout, OrdinaryKids produced over a decade of award-winning, thought-provoking work. By building mostly direct-to-client relationships, the studio shaped and augmented brands across the skate, architecture, and fashion worlds.

- Pioneered early Flash and creative-technology work that set a bar for interactive brand expression across sport, skate, fashion, music, and architecture.
- Delivered flagship brand work for Nike (Skateboarding, Running, Sportswear), Adidas Skateboarding, and Brita, alongside cultural projects for MoMA, Stüssy, HUF, Tracy Chapman, and Aesop Rock — including the “None Shall Pass” music video.
- Recognized with How Magazine Best of Show and a Communication Arts Interactive Annual cover; ran a small team that anchored the SF design scene and launched a generation of Bay Area careers.

DualForces · Partner & Creative Director

SEP 2010 — DEC 2013

A creative application studio working at the intersection of fashion, streetwear, and emerging culture — designing experiences that move fluidly between digital, physical, and cinematic worlds, merging art direction, technology, and cultural storytelling into one practice.

- Creative-directed the Nike Free visual center — the first public use of real Nike+ data in a marketing campaign — and produced a 56-page zine shot in London, NYC, and Tokyo.
- Ran the Nike FuelBand influencer campaign in NYC: 60+ events in 90 days with a large content team.
- Collaborated with Nike, Stüssy, UNDFTD, Vans OTW, Pepsi, DreamWorks, and SA Studios — work spanning digital products, retail environments, and large-scale installations.
- Produced a microsite and directed six short films for Nike NSW (Sportswear).

- How Magazine — Best of Show, Interactive Annual
- FWA — Site of the Day (multiple)
- Communication Arts — Interactive Annual (cover)
- Print Magazine — MoMA Design Takes on Risk
- One Club — Judge
- Featured in History of Web Design (Taschen)

REFERENCES

Jodi Twilleger

— ECD — Collins, Magic Leap, Hush

Justin Marr

— Design Director — Uber, Intuit

Phouphet Sihavong

— Director, Applied AI — Intuit

Tim Olson

— SVP Strategic Partnerships — KQED